

Wyoming Roadless Areas Survey

Purpose, Privacy, and Method

This public-facing note explains why the survey exists, how responses should be handled, and how results should be reported. It is written for survey users.

Purpose

This survey asks Wyoming voters what standards should guide decisions about inventoried roadless areas and forest management. It is education-focused. A short background section and definitions are provided before the questions so voters can answer with more context. The goal is to measure public input, not persuade toward a preferred answer.

How responses will be used

Responses should be published in aggregate. Exact question wording and response options should be published with results. Verified and unverified responses should be labeled separately when verification is used. Results may be summarized by Wyoming, county, State House district, or State Senate district when enough responses are available to protect privacy.

Privacy statement

Individual responses should not be published, sold, rented, or shared. Published results should not include names, email addresses, phone numbers, physical addresses, voter-file records, or individual answers. Open comments should not be published as individual quotes unless permission is requested and granted. Open comments may be summarized as broad themes.

Verification note

This survey is designed to gather Wyoming voter input. Responses may be checked against a lawful voter file or account record to confirm voter status and place verified responses in the correct county, State House district, or State Senate district. Verification protects the integrity of district-level reporting while keeping individual responses confidential.

What may be published

Aggregate totals, verified and unverified labels, district-level summaries when privacy can be protected, total response count, collection dates, exact question wording, response options, revision notes, method notes, and a limitations statement may be published.

What should not be published

Names, email addresses, phone numbers, physical addresses, voter-file records, individual answers, individual open-comment quotes without permission, or any information that could reasonably identify a specific voter should not be published.

Method

The survey should use plain language, balanced answer choices, and a visible Not sure option where appropriate. Source links should be placed in a separate learning document so the questions do not become argument text. If wording changes while the survey is live, a revision log should document the date, old wording, new wording, reason for change, and whether results need to be separated by version.

Limitations

This survey can show what participating voters believe. It cannot prove statewide opinion unless participation is broad enough and the method is clearly reported. Verified district results are useful for accountability, but low response counts should be treated cautiously.

Accountability note

Survey results do not replace representative judgment. The results create a public record that can be compared with future agency decisions, public statements, proposed legislation, or votes related to roadless areas and forest management.

Suggested file links on the survey page

- Purpose, Privacy, and Method PDF: explains how the survey works.
- Sources and Background PDF: provides learning links and neutral context.
- Results and Accountability PDF: added after responses are collected.